

Thistle Architecture

INITIAL RESEARCH

Luton Borough Council

HMO Space Standards Summary

7 OCCUPANTS

Research compiled by: Thistle Architecture/KT

Source: Luton Borough Council, Houses in Multiple Occupation Standards (Private Sector Housing Enforcement)

Date: July 2026

1. Bedroom Standards

Room Type	Minimum Size	Ceiling Height
1 person (aged over 10)	6.51 sqm	2.13m min*
2 persons (couple)	10.22 sqm**	2.13m min*
Person aged under 10	4.64 sqm	2.13m min*

*2.13m (2130mm) floor to ceiling. Where the ceiling slopes, 2.13m over at least 50% of the floor area. Floor area measured on a plane 1500mm above floor level; any area below 1500mm is disregarded. No room below 4.64 sqm may be used for sleeping.

**Two person (double) rooms: 10.22 sqm is the national mandatory licence condition (Licensing of HMOs (Mandatory Conditions of Licences) (England) Regulations 2018), applied by Luton. Rooms for two are normally suitable only for a couple or cohabitantes.

2. Kitchen & Communal Standards for 7 Occupants

Minimum Room Sizes (6 to 10 occupiers)

- Shared kitchen (no separate dining area): 11 sqm
- Kitchen-diner: 12.5 sqm
- Separate living room or dining room: 12.5 sqm

Where more than 5 occupiers share a kitchen with no separate dining area, additional facilities may be required. The kitchen must be no more than one floor from the bedrooms or dining area.

Kitchen Fittings

- Sinks: 2no sink and drainer, each min 500mm x 1000mm (ratio 1 per 5 occupiers). For 6 to 10 occupiers a double-bowled sink or a dishwasher in addition to a single sink may be accepted.
- Worktop: 2no fixed worktop, each min 500mm x 1500mm (1 per 5 occupiers), in addition to space for the sink, cooker and any large appliance.

- Cooking: 2no cooker (600mm, min 4 ring burners and grill), or 1no cooker plus microwaves as required.
- Sockets: 3no double sockets per 5 occupiers above the worktops, plus 1 per fixed appliance.
- Splashback: 300mm to sink and worktops where they abut a wall.

Provision for 7 Occupants

2 SINKS + 2 COOKERS (or 1 cooker plus microwaves) REQUIRED

3. Bathroom & WC for 7 Occupants

Facility	Required	Notes
Bathrooms	2	Each with bath/shower + wash basin (6 to 10 persons)
WCs	2	May be sited within the 2 separate bathrooms
Wash basin	550mm x 400mm	1 per bath/shower room (max 5 occupiers), 300mm splashback
Splashback / flooring	300mm tiled	Smooth, non-absorbent, easily cleaned

- A bathroom must be no more than one floor distant from the bedrooms; a toilet no more than one floor from living and bedrooms.
- A separate WC (not required until 9 occupiers) must have its own wash hand basin to count.
- Bath min: 1700mm x 700mm | Shower min compartment with fully tiled walls or a self-contained cubicle.
- En-suites count towards facility provision where in exclusive use.

4. Key Notes

- Licensing: all HMOs occupied by 5 or more people in 2 or more households sharing amenities require a licence in Luton, regardless of the number of storeys.
- Room sharing: persons over 10 must not share sleeping accommodation with a non-close-relative or someone of the opposite sex unless cohabiting.
- Natural light: glazed area to habitable rooms at least 1/10th of the floor area.
- Ventilation: openable window area at least 1/20th of the floor area; mechanical extract to kitchens, bathrooms and WCs.
- Window restrictors: required above ground floor where the sill is within 1100mm of floor level (open no more than 100mm, easily over-riden in a fire).
- Guarding: to stairs, balconies and landings min 1100mm high, no gap allowing a 100mm sphere to pass.
- Heating: capable of 21C in living/sleeping rooms and 22C in bathrooms when it is -1C outside.

5. Design Checklist

Type X in the Done column to mark complete

Requirement	Standard	Done
Single bedrooms (1 person)	>= 6.51 sqm	
Double bedrooms (couple)	>= 10.22 sqm	
Shared kitchen	>= 11 sqm	
Living / dining room	>= 12.5 sqm	

Sinks	2 (500 x 1000mm)	
Cookers	2 (or 1 + microwaves)	
Bathrooms	2 required	
WCs	2 (may be in bathrooms)	
Ceiling height	2.13m (50%)	
Bathroom / WC distance	Max 1 floor from beds	

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Research compiled by Thistle Architecture/KT from official council documentation.